PREPRINT (SUBMITTED VERSION)

Why the CPTPP could be an impetus for the new globalisation?

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Why the CPTPP Could Be an Impetus for the New Globalisation?

This paper investigates the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP) as a potential driving force for the emerging phase of globalisation, termed the "new globalisation." It introduces the "New Globalisation Scenario Matrix" (NGSM) to assess the CPTPP's role within this framework. Our study finds that the CPTPP aligns with a medium-high performance scenario, notably emphasizing environmental regulations that both counter climate change and anticipate challenges arising from increased cross-border trade and enhanced regional integration. As the world navigates pressing challenges today, the CPTPP emerges as a potentially important player, promoting trade liberalisation while upholding environmental protection, pointing the way for future international accords.

Keywords: CPTPP, New Globalisation, Environmental Regulations, Trade Liberalisation, Evolutionary Structural Triptych (EST), New Globalisation Scenario Matrix (NGSM), International Political Economy (IPE)

1. Introduction

The world is grappling with an array of ever-evolving challenges that span the socioeconomic spectrum. These notably include the 2008 global financial crisis (Blinder, 2013), the US-China trade war from 2018 onwards (Vlados, 2020), the post-COVID-19 digital and energy transitions (Muzio & Dow, 2022), and Russia's 2022 invasion of Ukraine (Babić et al., 2022). Such tumultuous events have prompted a reassessment of global economic, social, and political structures. As a result, there is increasing interest in International Political Economy (IPE) research. For several years now, this body of work has been increasingly characterising this evolving phase as the "new globalisation," suggesting that these events are merely the initial manifestations of this nascent phenomenon (Baldwin, 2016; Strohmer et al., 2020; Vlados, 2019; Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2021).

Agreements like the Trans-Pacific Partnership (TPP) and its successor, the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP), ratified in 2018, seem to emerge as hopeful developments and potential guiding posts in this evidently tumultuous socioeconomic environment. Notably, since its ratification, the CPTPP has become one of the world's most significant free-trade zones in terms of GDP (Goodman, 2018). Politically, however, this initiative has encountered numerous hurdles. During his 2016 presidential campaign speech, the Republican Party's nominee, Donald Trump, pledged to withdraw the United States from the TPP if he won the election, contending that the deal would "undermine" the US economy and sovereignty (Smith, 2017). On 23 January 2017, President Trump enacted a presidential memorandum to exit the US from the TPP. US Senator John McCain lambasted the move, stating it conveyed an unsettling message of US detachment in the Asia-Pacific when such disengagement was least desirable (Sink & Olorunnipa, 2017).

The existing literature on the intricacies of TPP/CPTPP appears not to have yet delved into its tangible relationship with the burgeoning new globalisation. Discussions have been centred on specific facets of the agreement without addressing the overarching structure of this emerging globalisation. For instance, there's expanding research into potential inequalities exacerbated by the agreement (Capaldo et al., 2016), the hegemonic shifts it might induce (Green & Goodman, 2015), and the dispute mechanism it utilises to assist investors (Dymond et al., 2021). Other studies have considered the advantages and disadvantages for specific member nations (Akimoto, 2019), developments in intellectual property rights underscored by the agreement (Nath Upreti, 2018), the liberal institutionalism it seemingly promotes (Takeuchi, 2020), and the strong environmental regulations it purportedly outlines (Deng & Huang, 2018). It is suggested that the agreement champions such environmental regulations, perhaps as a conscious effort to

counterbalance the potential impacts of diminished trade barriers and increased economic integration, which might unintentionally increase consumption, waste, and gas emissions (Meidinger, 2019).

However, there is a discernible gap in the literature, which seems to focus primarily on specific aspects of the agreement, rather than the broader trajectory of the emerging new globalisation. Broadly speaking, this matter hasn't been thoroughly examined within the context of IPE, leaving some ambiguities in our attempt to thoroughly comprehend it. Moreover, there's no identifiable discussion that specifically addresses how the environmental aspects of the agreement might or might not influence the overarching direction of this new globalisation. Specifically, this paper aims to answer two main research questions:

1) Why could the CPTPP be an impetus for the new globalisation?

2) What are the environmental consequences of the TPP/CPTPP in this emerging global stage?

To address this issue, we opted for one of the recent IPE methodologies that investigates the specificities of new globalisation: the "Evolutionary Structural Triptych" (EST). This approach amalgamates three-level observations from different political, economic, and technological-innovation structures. It posits that there's a nascent form of globalisation taking shape today. However, there are varied performance outcomes in the spheres of Geopolitical Stability (GS), Economic Development (ED), and Innovational Progress (IP) stemming from these structures (Vlados, 2019). Building on this, we present a novel framework birthed from the EST: the New Globalisation Scenario Matrix (NGSM). At its core, the NGSM is a tool that synthesises the various scenarios of new globalisation into a comprehensible integrative matrix. In a scenario of low performance, a new nation-

centric fragmentation is the likely result. In the medium-low tier of performance, there might be a partial nation-centric fragmentation. In turn, medium-high performance might indicate an emerging multipolarity, while high performance may herald a refreshed, innovative form of global liberalism. It appears that the TPP/CPTPP agreement aligns with the medium-high scenario, as several indicators within this category hint at such a potential progression.

To unpack this analysis, the article will commence with Section 2, which provides a concise overview of IPE generations in the relevant literature, culminating in the third generation from which the EST methodology springs. This sets the stage to better understand its evolution and pinpoint its research scope. Following this, Section 3 elucidates the EST and introduces the NGSM. Section 4 then presents our research findings, testing the TPP/CPTPP case against the NGSM. Section 5 interprets these results to draw definitive conclusions pertinent to the research questions, alongside considering theoretical implications, constraints, and avenues for future studies. Concluding, Section 6 encapsulates the research, clarifying further its salient message.

2. Literature Review

We contend that without a thorough examination of the IPE theme's evolution, one cannot fully grasp this issue. This is because the challenges presented by the current transformation phase of the world system can only be understood in the context of the historical progression and shifts in this theoretical domain over past decades. As a result, we will provide a concise overview of the crucial milestones in the development of IPE, which also forms the theoretical context for our discussion.

2.1. The Three Generations of the IPE

Initially, in the 1970s, the pioneering works and theoretical methodologies of the "first

generation" of contemporary IPE surfaced and began investigating the vibrant interrelationship between politics and the worldwide economy. As highlighted by Gilpin, this research avenue delved into the interaction between the market and influential bodies such as states, multinational firms, and international institutions (Gilpin, 2001, pp. 17–18). Broadly speaking, the foundational phase of IPE underscored that an all-encompassing theoretical understanding of international balances is paramount. Such comprehension is unattainable without a holistic approach to socioeconomic occurrences, incorporating both their political and economic facets and, subsequently, their geopolitical and developmental dimensions (Cox, 1981; Gilpin, 2001; Katzenstein, 1985; Kindleberger, 1973; Krasner, 1983; Strange, 1971).

Following this, the post-1980 era saw a marked proliferation of IPE studies. This expansion aimed to comprehend globalisation in holistic terms, transcending a restricted emphasis on issues specific to macroeconomic issues of international trade, as these were viewed mostly by the conventional neoclassical perspective (Nelson & Winter, 1982). The profound theoretical observations during this time elucidated approaches that, viewed together, simultaneously spanned to political, macroeconomic, corporate, technological, and geographical facets of the global setting (Cohen, 2008; Fukuyama, 1992; Hall & Soskice, 2001; Held, 1995; Huntington, 1996; Keohane & Nye Jr, 1998; Luttwak, 1990; Michalet, 2005; Robertson, 1992; Ruggie, 1982; Thurow, 1992).

Lastly, the third-generation IPE approaches have highlighted emerging global tendencies, enriching the theoretical dialogue, especially focusing on the influence of institutional components in the context of globalisation (Acemoglu & Robinson, 2012; Blinder, 2013; Ikenberry, 2011; Menz, 2017; O'Brien & Williams, 2016; Rodrik, 2011; Roger, 2020). Recently, another line of inquiry has started to explore the specificities of the emerging global system, without explicitly referencing the "new globalisation,"

concerned with the post-COVID-19 world (Muzio & Dow, 2022) and the implications of the Russian invasion in Ukraine (Babić et al., 2022). Nevertheless, these foundational works have not directly and unambiguously delved into emerging phase of the new globalisation. The subsequent section spotlights the most influential approaches that have endeavoured to elucidate this topic to date.

2.2. The "New Globalisation" in Third-Generation IPE

The third-generation IPE has led to the emergence of theories that delve deeply into the intricacies of the so-called "new globalisation." Some scholars posit that this new phase signifies a neo-colonial exploitation in Africa, potentially escalating tensions between industrialised nations and African states (Kieh, 2008). Some support a repositioning of Keynesian economics in the context of the new globalisation, while also considering that the BRICS nations emerge as pivotal players across various sectors (Dasgupta & Pieterse, 2009). The transformative potential of modern technological advancements within this globalisation wave has also been emphasized (Roach, 2009). Furthermore, the multilateral dimension of this era is evident in initiatives such as China's New Silk Road, which some interpret as an indication of diminishing "US hegemony" (Nobis, 2017).

Technologically, some propose that globalisation undergoes phases of divergence and convergence, predominantly driven by technological advancements (Baldwin, 2016). Another critical perspective suggests that there is an underlying development of the Fourth Industrial Revolution, which is a turning point in technology that intertwines the digital, biological, and physical realms, and here, the integration of computational and tangible worlds signifies transformative impacts on society, governance, and our very identity (Schwab, 2016). There's also a perspective that foresees a fragmented global economy, influenced by emerging markets, where political agendas might eclipse

common economic objectives (Bhattacharya et al., 2017). Another perspective is that four potential trajectories for the new global order include, based on what they bring in terms geopolitical cohesion and economic growth: Globalisation 3.0, emphasizing robust economic growth and increased geopolitical cohesion; Polarization, marked by economic and political rivalry with moderate growth and cohesion; Islandisation, dominated by nationalism and protectionism leading to diminished global flows and cohesion; and Commonisation, an altruistic future driven by sharing economies and millennial preferences, prioritizing economic growth over geopolitical cohesion (Strohmer et al., 2020).

A different viewpoint suggests that the emerging new globalisation is seen as the latest phase in post-World War II (postwar) evolution, resulting from significant structural adjustments in political, economic, and technological structures (Vlados, 2019). Another viewpoint is concerned with the recent US-China trade war initiated in 2018, viewing it as an additional incident contributing to the ongoing crisis and restructuring of the global socioeconomic system, necessitating the step-by-step development of a novel global architecture (Vlados, 2020). While recognising the benefits of digital technology, some caution against its potential to intensify inequalities and stress the imperative for enhanced governance (Killian, 2021). Some deem Rodrik's trilemma, which posits the incompatibility of maintaining national sovereignty, democracy, and global integration simultaneously, as outdated, noting that BRICS nations must now play an equal role in upholding global stability, reinforcing their democratic institutions, and adapting their national sovereignty while integrating into new global structures (Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2021). Another angle posits that the COVID-19 pandemic has hastened the energy transition in the emerging new globalisation, underscoring the importance of re-evaluating development with ecological considerations (Chatzinikolaou & Vlados,

2022). Additionally, some believe that free trade agreements, such as the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP), augment regional economic and social cohesion and might enhance global transnational flows, thus fostering effective cooperation and reshaping the emerging dynamics of the new globalisation (Vlados et al., 2022).

In essence, the discourse surrounding the transition to a "new globalisation" era is dynamic and multifaceted. While many theories highlight its complex contemporary composition, the exact characteristics of this forthcoming phase remain elusive. This emerging system is expected to retain elements from the prior globalisation phase but will be moulded by nascent socioeconomic frameworks, giving rise to a "new global geometry." The exact characteristics and dynamics of this phase remain in flux.

3. Methodology

3.1. The Evolutionary Structural Triptych (EST)

The preceding section highlighted the growing emphasis in recent IPE research on the intricacies of the newly emerging globalisation. If viewed from a synthesising perspective, these approaches appear to integrate political, economic, and technological structures. However, as evidenced in the prior section, many IPE perspectives tend to prioritise analyses for just two of these dimensions, such as the interplay between political and economic structures (Strohmer et al., 2020) or between technological and economic structures (Baldwin, 2016; Schwab, 2016).

Nevertheless, the EST framework, which outlines the distinct evolutionary stages of the postwar world system (Vlados, 2019), appears to sufficiently integrate the political, economic, and technological structures of each period. Building upon this, the EST leads to an three-dimensional integrative framework, focusing on three pivotal dimensions

derived from studying political, economic, and technological structures. These are: A) geopolitical stability, B) economic development, and C) innovational progress (Figure 1).

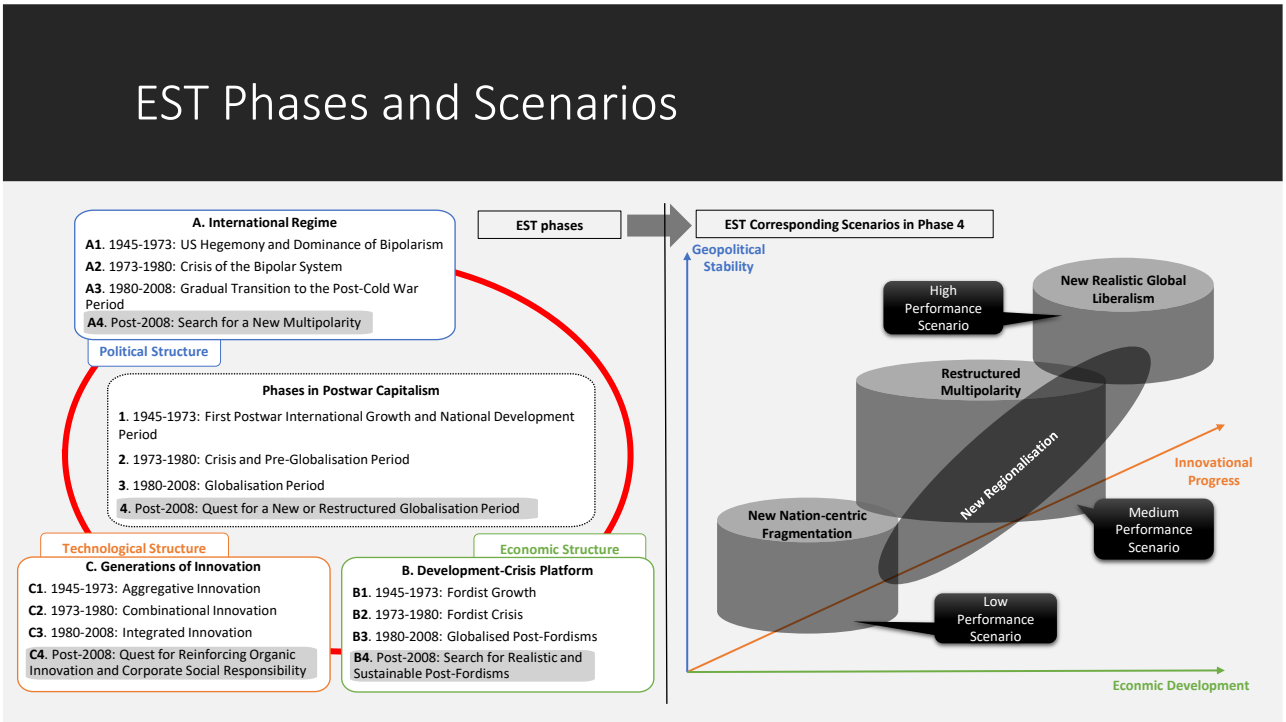


Figure 1: EST phases and scenarios

Based on the EST framework, there are four distinct phases identified in the historical evolution of postwar capitalism, starting from 1945 and extending to the post-2008 world system. It's important to note that specific years like 1945, 1973, 1980, and 2008 are not chosen arbitrarily. Instead, they represent pivotal moments in historical transitions, serving as milestones in an ongoing sequence of change. The phases are detailed as follows:

1) The first postwar international growth and national development period (1945-1973)

2) The crisis and pre-globalisation period (1973-1980)

3) The globalisation period (1980-2008)

4) The quest for a new or restructured globalisation period (post-2008).

Within the EST framework, the term "political structure" refers to the prevailing international political regimes, deeply rooted in geopolitical systems (Krasner, 1983). "Economic structure" refers to models of socioeconomic development, encompassing elements like production and investment, and guiding preferences for liberal or coordinated market economies within the "varieties of capitalism" framework (Hall & Soskice, 2001).[1] The "technological structure" pertains to the prevailing innovative paradigms of each period, capturing more than mere technology but the multifaceted essence of innovation and its transformative impact (Schumpeter, 1942).[2]

In the context of the emerging new globalisation (corresponding to phase 4), outcomes can be segmented into three distinct tiers: low, medium, and high. The low tier might witness nations adopting a more inward-looking stance. The medium bracket foresees a multipolar world with regional hubs of economic, geopolitical, and innovative

[1] Fordism is a historical development-crisis model that encompassed economic-institutional facets, featuring mass production, value-added distribution, and steady business profitability (Lipietz, 1993). In contrast, Post-Fordism is frequently characterised as a stage emphasising flexibility, decentralisation, and specialised production, marking a departure from traditional Fordist principles (Boyer & Durand, 1993).

[2] In this vein, Rothwell delineated various postwar innovation generations, pinpointing the prevailing model of each period (Rothwell, 1994). He charted postwar innovation trends, such as the linear innovation of the 1950s and 1960s, be it market-push or market-pull, the combined linear model of the 1970s, the integrated strategy of the 1980s that harmonised internal and external environments, and the ongoing innovation from the 1990s, underscoring internal system cohesion and expansive networks.

prowess, suggesting potential strengthened regional alliances. Conversely, the high tier envisions a cohesive global landscape marked by unwavering stability, flourishing economic growth, and groundbreaking innovations.

3.2. The New Globalisation Scenario Matrix (NGSM)

Building upon the four phases outlined earlier, we propose a matrix detailing various scenarios for the new globalisation, depicted in Figure 2. The matrix is constructed with New Regionalisation on the analytical centre and with four distinct scenarios categorised by performance levels (low, medium-low, medium-high, and high) in the EST's three structures: Geopolitical Stability (GS), Economic Development (ED), and Innovational Progress (IP).

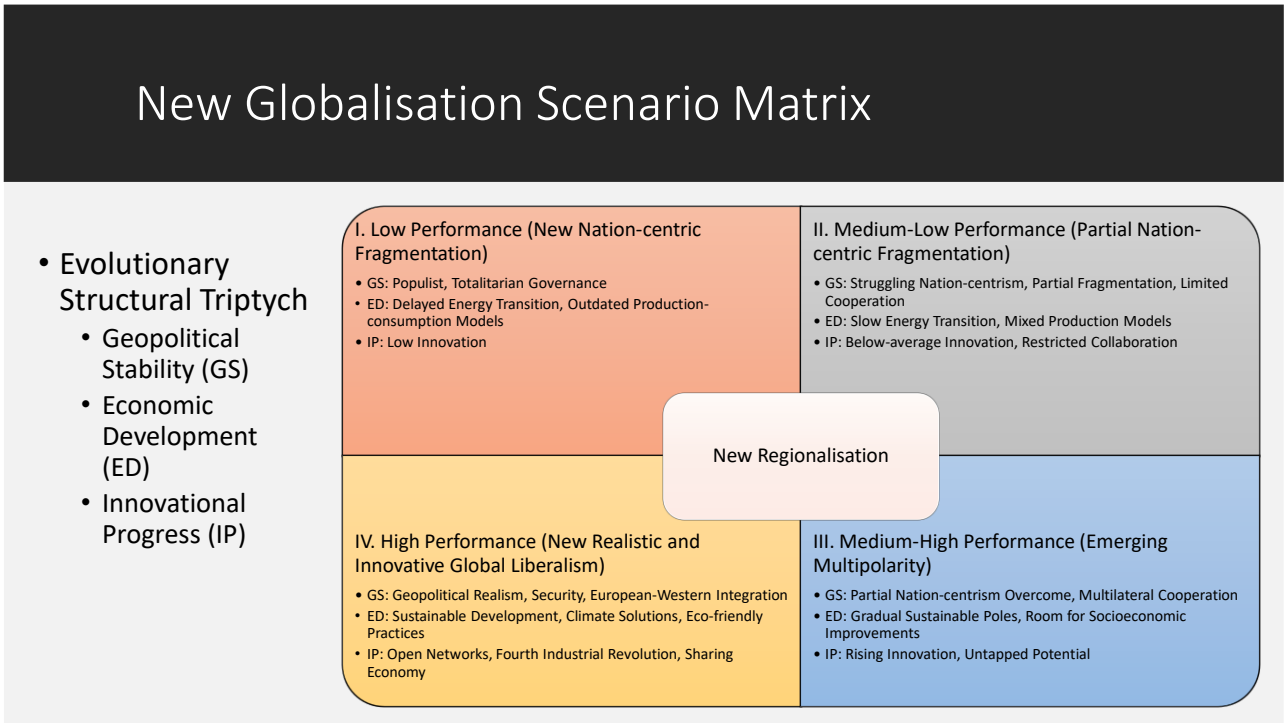


Figure 2: New Globalisation Scenario Matrix

In the context of the new globalisation, regionalisation, which refers to the increased integration and cooperation among countries within a specific region, marks a shift from

old regionalism to new regionalism, and further to open regionalism, which places greater emphasis on openness, transparency, and cooperation with external actors (Sunkel & Inotai, 2016). Regionalisation is a prominent feature in all four scenarios of the NGSM as it reflects the evolving nature of globalisation and the importance of regional cooperation in addressing various challenges, such as geoeconomic imbalances and environmental concerns. The performance scenarios are the following:

I. Low Performance (New Nation-centric Fragmentation): This scenario encompasses potential trends towards increased structures of populist and totalitarian governance (GS), delayed energy transition and outdated models (ED), and low innovation (IP). It might mirror the nation-centric fragmentation and protectionist tendencies seen during the interwar period (Cornell et al., 2020).

II. Medium-Low Performance (Partial Nation-Centric Fragmentation): GS here might feature struggling nation-centrism, partial fragmentation, and limited cooperation. ED could be marked by a sluggish energy transition and mixed production models, while IP might showcase below-par innovation and constrained cooperation. This potential scenario might correspond to unsuccessful endeavours to transcend nation-centrism.

III. Medium-High Performance (Emerging Multipolarity): This scenario might include a decline in nation-centrism, replaced by multilateral collaboration in GS. Gradual sustainable poles with potential for socioeconomic improvements could characterise ED, while IP might encompass rising innovation with untapped potential. This scenario could exhibit medium-scale performance in all three structures, potentially leading to enhanced regional forms, generating relative geopolitical

stability, cohesive socioeconomic development, and innovational progress globally.

IV. High Performance (New Realistic and Innovative Global Liberalism): This scenario might encompass geopolitical realism and security, bolstered by deeper European-Western integration (GS); sustainable development, climate solutions, and eco-friendly practices (ED); and open networks, the consolidation of the fourth industrial revolution, and a sharing economy (IP). This "new realistic and innovative global liberalism" could represent a new ideological-political horizon, emphasising inclusiveness, renewal, and effectiveness, while upholding principles of freedom, democracy, and pluralism. The aim would be to create a balanced, sustainable globalisation and mitigate risks of social, economic, and political destabilisation (Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2021).

A crucial aspect of the EST is the coevolution of its dimensions. In situations where geopolitical instability coincides with stagnant economic growth, there might be insufficient resources and profitability to drive substantial innovation. Such tepid economic growth, coupled with a lacklustre innovation drive, can politically undermine any socioeconomic structure. Consequently, these structures might face poverty and technological stagnation. It's improbable in such contexts for one of the three dimensions to excel while the others lag, given their interwoven nature. This dialectic interplay is also palpable in moderate or high-performance scenarios. For example, attaining high-performance requires aligning robust geopolitical stability with a budding multipolarity, potentially nurturing sustainable economic growth anchored in open innovations (Chesbrough, 2003).

By extension, when we examine the postwar capitalism, the EST could be useful for analysing the role and impact of trade agreements such as the TPP/CPTPP on the global socioeconomic system. The NGSM further highlights the importance of regionalisation in shaping the future of globalisation, with varying performance scenarios that reflect potential outcomes of geopolitical stability, economic development, and innovational progress. As the subsequent section is explored, these scenarios will prove useful in shedding light on the implications of the TPP/CPTPP for the evolving global system.

4. Results

4.1. TPP/CPTPP Timeline

The CPTPP, also known as TPP11 or TPP-11, traces its roots back to the P4 Agreement in 2005-2006, initially signed by Brunei, Chile, New Zealand, and Singapore. Subsequently, the TPP expanded to encompass the US, Australia, Peru, Vietnam, Malaysia, Canada, Mexico, and Japan between 2008 and 2012. By 2015, the TPP terms had gained consensus from all 12 participating countries, and the accord was officially ratified in New Zealand in 2016.

However, following the US withdrawal from the TPP in 2017, the CPTPP emerged in 2018, which incorporated the remaining 11 countries. This revised agreement preserved two-thirds of the TPP's provisions, suspended 22 measures favoured by the US, and adjusted the enactment threshold to function without US participation (Goodman, 2018). As depicted in Figure 3, the CPTPP came into effect in December 2018 and has since become one of the world's largest free-trade areas by GDP—accounting for approximately 15.8 percent of global GDP (Government of Canada, 2023).

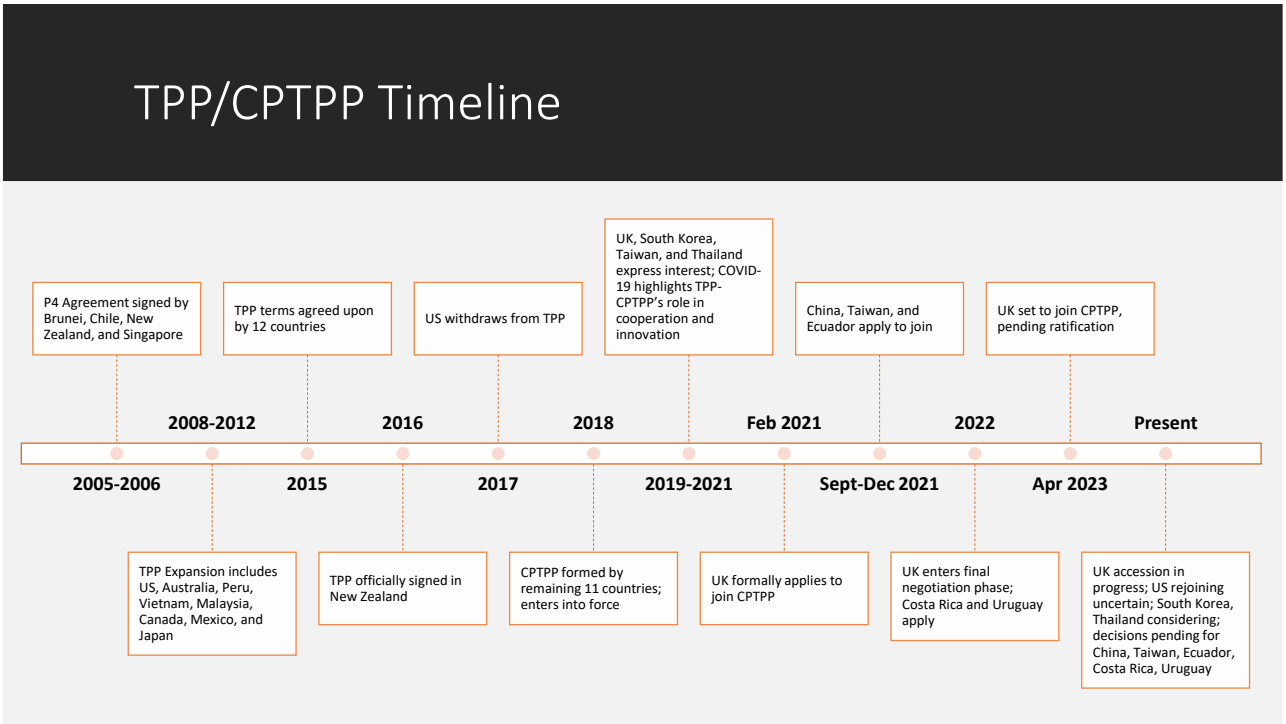


Figure 3: TPP/CPTPP timeline

In the subsequent years since the CPTPP's formation, various countries, including the UK, South Korea, Taiwan, and Thailand, have expressed interest in joining. The UK formally applied to join the CPTPP in February 2021, and by 2022, it had entered the final negotiation phase. Several other countries, including China, Taiwan, Ecuador, Costa Rica, and Uruguay, have also applied to join, with their applications currently under consideration. As of April 2023, the UK is on track to join the CPTPP, subject to ratification.

As the UK's accession to the CPTPP advances and other nations contemplate joining, the future US participation remains uncertain. However, the continued expansion of the CPTPP underscores its importance in the global economy, and its influential role in shaping international trade, cooperation, and innovation. In 2023, New Zealand presides over the CPTPP, which continues to adapt to the fluctuating demands and requirements of the global market.

In terms of its legal structure, the CPTPP is an encompassing trade agreement involving 11 countries, addressing a wide range of trade and commerce aspects. These include market access, rules of origin, textiles, customs administration, trade remedies, sanitary measures, technical barriers, investment, cross-border services, financial services, business entry, telecommunications, e-commerce, government procurement, competition policy, state-owned enterprises, intellectual property, labour, environment, cooperation, competitiveness, development, small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), regulatory coherence, transparency, anti-corruption, dispute settlement, and final provisions. The TPP/CPTPP agreement also includes annexes on non-conforming measures for various sectors.

4.2. TPP/CPTPP and its NGSM-based Analysis

Analysing the TPP/CPTPP within the NGSM framework, it seemingly aligns with the Medium-High Performance scenario. A range of potential indicators suggests that the agreement could indeed indicate a shift in this direction, as illustrated in Figure 4.

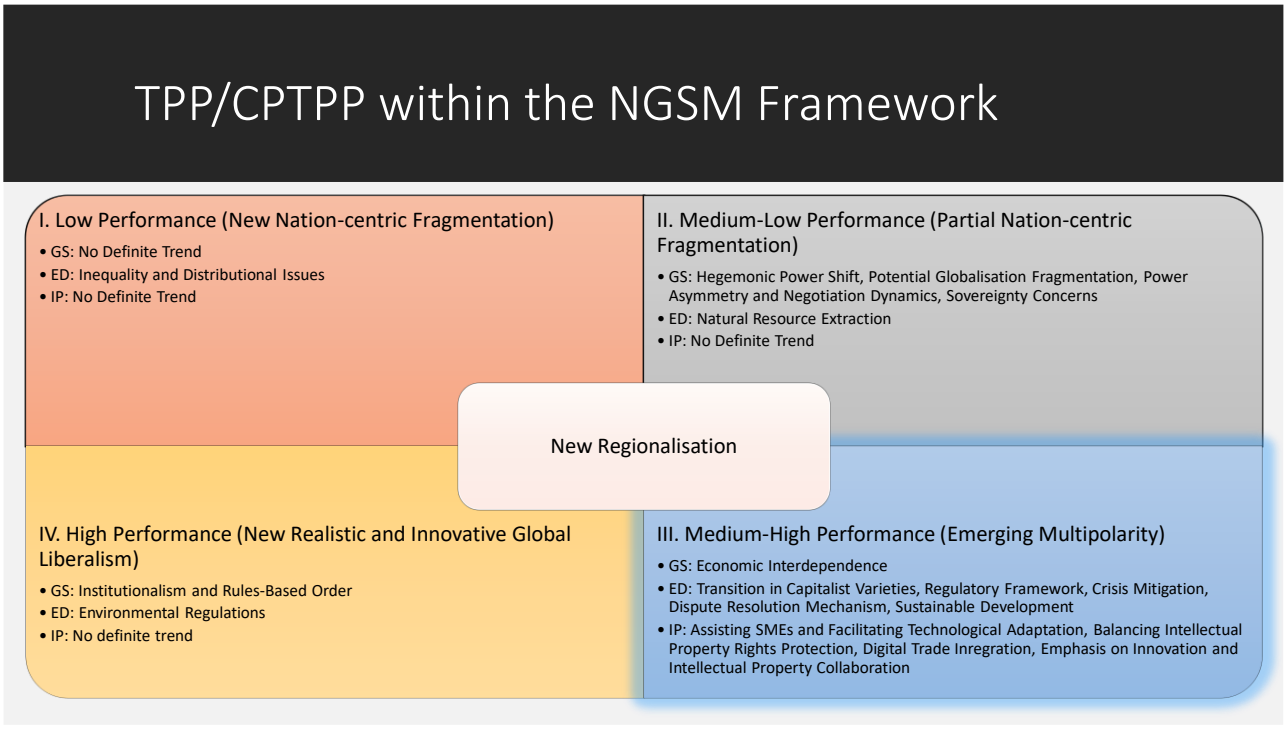


Figure 4: TPP/CPTPP within the NGSM Framework

Notably, the TPP/CPTPP doesn't show strong indications of GS concerns related to Low Performance. However, within the ED pillar, pronounced issues of inequality and distribution emerge. Moreover, there's a clear absence of IP trends in this scenario:

- Inequality and Distributional Issues: A report predicted that the TPP would adversely affect employment, with estimates suggesting a loss of 450,000 US jobs, 75,000 Japanese jobs, 58,000 Canadian jobs, and 5,000 New Zealand jobs by 2025. Alarmingly, according to the same, the total job loss figure stands at 771,000, while the anticipated positive economic impacts for member nations would be relatively minor (Capaldo et al., 2016). Such troubling finding hint that the TPP/CPTPP might actually amplify existing disparities both within and among nations. The benefits of trade liberalisation and investment protection could disproportionately aid large enterprises and advanced countries, occasionally resulting in diminished economic growth and a slower pace of global energy transition.

The Medium-Low Performance scenario suggests potential hegemonic power shift and an apparent fragmentation in globalisation. Within the GS pillar, there are emerging concerns about sovereignty, power asymmetry, and intensified negotiation dynamics. Concurrently, there's potential intensification of resource extraction within ED, though no definitive trend is evident in IP:

- Hegemonic Power Shift: Japan's ex-PM Shinzo Abe assessed that the TPP might pacify the Asia-Pacific region (Perlez, 2015). President Obama remarked that without the TPP, countries like China would dictate rules (Calmes, 2015). US Trade Representative Froman noted that without the TPP, China could set Asia

Pacific standards via the RCEP (Taj, 2016). US Secretary of Defence equated the TPP's value to a new aircraft carrier for the US (Green & Goodman, 2015). All these statements underscore the GS traits, indicating a reduced emphasis on cooperation and evident nation-centric challenges.

- Potential Globalisation Fragmentation: President Trump withdrew the US from the TPP on 23 January 2017, leading to mixed reactions. US Senator McCain voiced concerns about diminished American influence in the Asia-Pacific. He further noted the potential of China joining the TPP with broad exemptions, an action that could dilute the agreement's stringent standards (Sink & Olorunnipa, 2017; Solís, 2021). Conversely, Senator Sanders saw it as a halt to damaging trade deals, highlighting a US' divided stance on globalisation (Smith, 2017). This mirrors a struggle for national interests over global cooperation, with US politics exemplifying this trend.

- Power Asymmetry and Negotiation Dynamics: New Zealand's Prime Minister, Jacinda Ardern, aimed to modify the TPP in 2017 to restrict domestic property purchases by foreign investors (*Ardern to Push for TPP Changes*, 2017). She believed in balancing affordable housing with trade objectives. Yet, power imbalances persist. US Senator Warren highlighted that corporations heavily influence US trade talks, with 85% of advisory seats held by corporate executives or lobbyists (Lee, 2016). The TPP negotiations reinforce such asymmetries, with smaller nations like Singapore, New Zealand, and Chile navigating larger powers like the US and Japan. This underscores an apparent tension between national interests and global cooperation, with nations hesitant to cede power for global trade benefits.

- Sovereignty Concerns: Critics suggest the CPTPP's Investor-State Dispute Settlement (ISDS) system may erode national sovereignty, enabling corporations to challenge government decisions. Senator Warren cited a French firm suing Egypt over a wage rise as an example against ISDS in TPP (Warren, 2015). However, the CPTPP introduces measures like joint interpretation clauses and mandates that local remedies be exhausted before arbitration, differentiating it from the RCEP (Dymond et al., 2021). In light of GS, there's a perceived partial fragmentation, with divided opinions on whether the agreement prioritises corporate benefits over national interests.

- Natural Resource Extraction: The Institute for Agriculture and Trade Policy argues that trade agreements like TPP may increase conflicts between trade rules and climate objectives, boosting trade in extractive sectors and potentially hampering climate efforts (Lilliston, 2016). While TPP/CPTPP's Chapter 20 discusses environmental issues (Government of Canada, 2016), the agreement may fall short in championing renewables and could overly protect corporate interests, possibly slowing the energy transition.

In the Medium-High Performance scenario, the GS pillar suggests an increased economic interdependence. The ED pillar indicates potential capitalist transition, refined regulations, crisis mitigation, dispute resolution enhancement, and a potential step towards sustainable development. Meanwhile, the IP pillar hints at supporting SMEs, technology adaptation, balanced IP rights, integrating digital trade, and an innovation focus:

- Economic Interdependence: Former Japan PM, Naoto Kan, expressed desire for TPP negotiations in 2010, discussing the visions of the East Asian Community

and arguing in favor of external openness (Akimoto, 2019, p. 3). Some propose that the EU should join the CPTPP for its economic and geopolitical advantages (Draper & McDonagh, 2021, p. 3). Thus, examining the characteristics of this scenario in the context of GS, the TPP/CPTPP could result in partially overcoming nation-centric views and fostering multilateral cooperation. It could potentially bridge interests between the West and the East, bolstering global security over time.

- Transition of Capitalist Varieties: Many TPP members see it as a pragmatic approach to new trade liberalisation (Lewis, 2011). The TPP may introduce a novel governance form for the Asia-Pacific and global trade (Petri & Plummer, 2012). On 30 January 2015, the UK's former Foreign Secretary, Philip Hammond, labelled the TPP as a significant liberalising step (Hammond, 2015). Hence, the TPP/CPTPP agreement might indicate a shift towards liberal-market economies (Hall & Soskice, 2001). However, this potential is tempered by opposing forces, despite the agreement's evident potential for socioeconomic advancement.

- Regulatory Framework: In May 2015, US Congressman Levin critiqued the enforceability of trade deals, pointing to Vietnam's labour standards (Greenhouse, 2015). Yet, some highlight the TPP's push for labour reforms in countries like Vietnam and Mexico. Furthermore, the agreement defines regional standards in intellectual property, labour, and environmental protection (Santos, 2019, pp. 36–37). Examining this situation in the context of ED, there's an apparent gradual shift towards enhancing the regulatory framework for countries involved in this trade agreement.

- Crisis Mitigation: The US International Trade Commission predicts the TPP will

benefit the US economy, with various sectors gaining differently (United States & International Trade Commission, 2016). The World Bank suggests the TPP could raise GDP and trade among member countries (World Bank, 2016). Given these traits, the CPTPP might foster a more robust economic climate for its members, potentially mitigating future economic downturns.

- Dispute Resolution Mechanism: The US Trade Representative (USTR) highlights that ISDS necessitates specific treaty breaches, not just "lost profits" (USTR, 2015). According to the White House, while over 3,000 trade agreements have investment protections with neutral arbitration, the US, party to 50 such agreements, has faced only 13 ISDS cases, never losing one (Zients, 2015). Despite concerns, the ISDS includes safeguards for host states regarding environmental and health policies (Gantz, 2022, pp. 321–325). Hence, with these safeguards and the prevalence of investment protections in most trade deals, this illustrates a gradual move towards sustainable development among participating states. Such provisions, while risky for some, offer essential investment security, vital for today's economic growth.

- Sustainable Development: President Obama cited the TPP's influence on Malaysia's efforts against human trafficking (Politifact, 2016). The USTR also stated the TPP enforces obligations to protect union rights and eliminate child and forced labour (USTR, 2016). Thus, there are trends towards improved sustainable development. However, while the ED pillar suggests potential for socioeconomic growth, the support for renewables seems less substantial, as earlier discussed under Natural Resource Extraction.

- Assisting SMEs and Facilitating Technological Adaptation: The Government of

Canada states the CPTPP may boost SMEs by removing tariffs on 99% of exports to CPTPP nations, easing trade access, and addressing global business barriers (Government of Canada, 2015). The TPP/CPTPP aims to strengthen SMEs by providing tools to protect intellectual property (Chapter 18) and promoting trade-focused policies (Chapter 23). However, the agreement's real impact on SMEs is uncertain due to still limited evidence, despite potential for innovation and socioeconomic growth.

- Balancing Intellectual Property Rights Protection: The USTR claims the TPP promotes innovation through stringent patent and copyright rules (USTR, 2016). CPTPP, however, suspended some TPP provisions, striving for a balanced IP protection, especially concerning pharmaceuticals and creativity (Nath Upreti, 2018, p. 100). This change intends to protect innovators and address biases in different industry settings. The effectiveness of these provisions in spurring innovation remains to be verified.

- Digital Trade Integration: The Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS) suggests the CPTPP could revolutionise digital trade (Suominen, 2021). Its provisions are meant to facilitate data flow across borders, with Chapter 14 (Electronic Commerce) emphasising free data access and transfer with privacy measures. This suggests potential digital innovation, although its full impact is not yet confirmed.

- Emphasis on Innovation and Intellectual Property Collaboration: The CPTPP, as per the Australian Government Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade, sets standard IP rules to boost investment in creativity and curb piracy (Australian Government Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade, 2019). Chapters 18 and 23

encourage innovation and collaboration in copyright issues. Potential benefits from these rules are still untapped.

In the High Performance context, there's a notable alignment with some positive trends. These include a distinct shift towards stronger institutionalism and a rules-based system in the GS pillar, along with a focused commitment to specific environmental regulations that benefit the climate. This doesn't show significant indications of IP within this scenario.

- Institutionalism and Rules-Based Order: According to the USTR, signatories must join the United Nations Convention Against Corruption (UNCAC), criminalise bribery of public officials, establish a code of conduct for such officials, implement measures to reduce conflicts of interest, enforce anti-corruption laws effectively, and engage private organisations in anti-corruption efforts (USTR, 2016). This underscores that the TPP/CPTPP champions the principles of liberal institutionalism in this regard (Takeuchi, 2020, p. 4), fostering stability and collaboration through international bodies.

- Environmental Regulations: The USTR states the TPP has the strongest enforceable environmental commitments in any trade agreement's history (USTR, 2016). It mandates signatories to address illegal fishing, endorse sustainable fisheries, protect wetlands and crucial natural zones, counter wildlife trafficking, illegal logging, and defend marine ecosystems from shipping pollution, aligning with MARPOL (an international agreement to prevent marine pollution) provisions (USTR, 2016). Several experts highlight the pact's fusion of environmental care with global trade, its bolstered adherence to Multilateral Environmental Agreements, and its push for public participation and transparency

(Meidinger, 2019, pp. 175, 195). Despite criticism on its environmental and labour stance being overshadowed by trade liberalisation (Chodor, 2019, pp. 246–248), the TPP/CPTPP, through Chapter 20, coherently focuses on vital environmental areas like ozone preservation, marine conservation, and biodiversity (Deng & Huang, 2018, pp. 511, 516–530, 543). These steps are seen as impactful advances for immediate climate solutions, fitting the high-strand scenario in the ED pillar.

5. Discussion

By synthesising upon the presented discourse related to the examined agreement, we arrive at specific key findings. Our study firstly indicated that the TPP/CPTPP agreement could contribute to a new phase of globalisation, aligning with a medium-high scenario. This is underpinned by noteworthy advancements observed in all the key structural pillars examined: GS, ED, and IP. Secondly, the agreement distinctly emphasises environmental regulations. Many of its provisions can be considered pioneering, instigating immediate impacts within member states and actively assisting in the fight against climate change. This emphasis probably emerges in response to the environmental challenges inherent in the agreement's ambitions, such as reducing trade barriers and enhancing economic integration. These could inadvertently augment consumption, waste, and emissions. The robust environmental clauses in the agreement could be a deliberate attempt to mitigate these potential effects.

Comparing our results with prior studies, our findings initially align with the third-generation IPE, which delves into the specificities of an emerging globalisation form. The TPP/CPTPP's leaning towards a medium-high performance scenario is consistent with this area of research. Specifically, the agreement seems to encourage a move beyond nation-focused fragmentation in GS, a trend observed in other recent large free trade

agreements (Vlados et al., 2022). Moreover, the agreement appears to make headway in advocating sustainability, particularly noteworthy given the participation of developing economies. This is congruent with the IPE narrative emphasising the rising sway of such economies on future economic trajectories (Bhattacharya et al., 2017; Strohmer et al., 2020; Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2021). The spotlight on digital trade and its associated intellectual property also reflects the IPE's focus on the untapped possibilities in the digital and IT sectors (Baldwin, 2016; Schwab, 2016). Secondly, from an environmental perspective, the agreement adeptly incorporates rigorous environmental regulations to counterbalance potential negative impacts from its primary aims, thus appealing to prospective members and underscoring its profound environmental commitment, given the increasing global environmental awareness (Chatzinikolaou & Vlados, 2022; Meidinger, 2019).

Regarding the implications of our findings and the essential prerequisites for the agreement to appear as an impetus for the emerging new globalisation, it's paramount to highlight that the TPP/CPTPP could be a reinforcement toward this new globalisation phase. It seems capable of championing trade liberalisation and counteract China's ascendance, especially considering its predominantly illiberal internal governance, even without US involvement. However, its influence could inadvertently splinter globalisation should China enter with significant concessions, leading to the emergence of competitive economic blocs (Sink & Olorunnipa, 2017; Solís, 2021). The onus is on the agreement to elevate participating nations from low-performance scenarios to higher echelons of the NGSM. Addressing the issues of inequality and distribution within the ED pillar, as identified in our research, is paramount (Capaldo et al., 2016). In future, the agreement's core goal should be to transcend low performance, leveraging its strong points, particularly those synchronous with high-performance scenarios. This entails

further endorsing the tenets of liberal institutionalism and building on the momentum of addressing environmental challenges.

This research is not devoid of limitations. While our primary focus was on the TPP/CPTPP agreement, incorporating perspectives from political, economic, and innovative-technological angles, potential oversight of other geopolitical events and trade agreements may limit our findings' scope and depth. Also, our method was purely qualitative, deriving insights from official documents, legal texts, and existing literature, based on the EST and expanded upon the introduced NGSM framework. Even though our conclusions were somewhat based on the observation that a predominant number of potential indicators manifested in the medium-high performance scenario, we strived to elucidate this as thoroughly as feasible employing qualitative analysis. It's worth noting that while we classified certain indicators into specific scenarios based on an analysis of the underlying trends, it doesn't preclude the possibility of these indicators fitting into multiple scenarios altogether.

In light of these limitations, there's room for deeper exploration. Future studies might probe other trade agreements or geopolitical events to discern their impact on new globalisation patterns. They could also undertake a more thorough assessment of pacts like the TPP/CPTPP, examining facets beyond this study's purview. Future studies could enhance the NGSM by integrating statistical approaches and adapting its identified indicators into a measurable index format. By re-examining the TPP/CPTPP case study with this perspective, subsequent research can more comprehensively validate this study's findings and delve into their implications for future investigations.

6. Conclusion

Our research emphasises two significant findings concerning the TPP/CPTPP's position

within the unfolding global framework. Firstly, the agreement carries the capability to contribute toward a new phase of globalisation, closely aligned with a medium-high performance trajectory. Secondly, the TPP/CPTPP firmly roots itself in forward-thinking environmental regulations, introducing measures that both address climate change and aim to offset potential environmental challenges stemming from its primary goals of trade enhancement and a new regional integration.

The outcomes of our study are potentially salient for grasping the specificities of the newly emerging global era, spotlighting the TPP/CPTPP as a key player. This agreement promotes trade liberalisation and can potentially offset China's ascendancy, fostering a more inclusive multipolar world, even without US participation. Yet, there's an inherent risk: China's inclusion, accompanied by significant concessions, might trigger the formation of competing economic blocs. For the TPP/CPTPP to genuinely unlock its transformative power, it must strive to meet high-performance standards. This demands a steadfast dedication to liberal institutionalism principles, taking full advantage of its environmentally-friendly disposition, whilst simultaneously counteracting this agreement's potential in exacerbating disparities.

In an increasingly tumultuous global system, challenges are constantly emerging across the socioeconomic spectrum. This is evident in events such as the 2008 global financial crisis, the US-China trade dispute from 2018 onwards, the COVID-19 pandemic of 2019-2020, and Russia's 2022 invasion of Ukraine. Amidst this backdrop, agreements like the TPP/CPTPP symbolise a step towards a hopeful direction. However, the efficacy of this agreement hinges on its ability to harmonise the often-conflicting interests of trade expansion and environmental conservation, especially in the face of the pressing challenges of climate change. The traditional global model of economic growth, built on mere expansion, seems increasingly infeasible due to the paramount environmental

constraints. Consequently, it's imperative for the CPTPP initiative to deepen its integration of environmental concerns in its decision-making process. While there are indications of this integration, there remains a need to strike a balance between trade growth and sustainable management. For trade agreements of the future, it's vital to maintain adaptability, agility, and alignment with the overarching goal of sustainability. This is particularly relevant in the dawn of a new globalisation era where achieving even medium-high economic performance requires navigating not just trade intricacies but also geopolitical stability and innovation challenges. In essence, out study of the TPP/CPTPP underscores the complex interplay between progressive liberal institutionalism and environmental regulations—both being critical in crafting our collective future.

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